



ORIENTATION — INSTITUTIONAL MENTAL MODEL

Document ID: SH-J2-ORIENT-001 | **Version:** 1.0.0 | **State:** LOCKED DIRECTION

Owner: Orientation | **Related:** EIB, Canon, executive/board/finance placement | **Cross-reference:** ORIENTATION_OFFICER_PROFESSION.md; EIB_AND_ENTERPRISE_QUESTIONS.md

Orientation owns the EIB, enterprise questions and assumptions, changes of mind, reorientation, consequential dissent travel, intellectual history, learning-to-education identification, Canon, and epistemic integrity in executive/board decisions. It does not own collection, investigations, line strategy, IT, generic communications, execution follow-up, command, or Internal Audit.

Orientation lives close to J2 HQ, CEO, and board interface. An officer may intervene when material uncertainty is presented as fact, dissent omitted, confidence overstated, or a known information deficiency matters. The officer does not vote, direct outcome, automatically delay, or own the agenda. "Noted and proceeding" is valid.

Vocation and anti-court bargain

Approximately 20–25 commissioned officers is the working target; trainees/fellows may sit outside it. Possible Officer/Senior/Distinguished ranks are PROVISIONAL. In exchange for compensation, access, freedom, research, sabbaticals, field exposure, education, and prestige, an ordinary commissioned officer permanently gives up later C-suite line office, operating VP authority, voting board membership, and equivalent decision power. Whether a former Head may later become a nonexecutive director remains OPEN.

Officers do not supervise line staff, own operating deliverables/budgets, conduct personnel actions, gatekeep executives/calendars, broker politics, map who is "up/down," keep private intelligence for leverage, claim "we" for executive decisions, or turn access into future power. Material institutional information returns through proper channels. Alexandria preserves judgments/dissents/assumptions/decisions, not a forensic blame graph of interpersonal influence.

Executive assignments rotate roughly 24–36 months and are styled "Orientation Officer assigned to the Office of the CEO," never a person's possession. Most officers also work enterprise questions, EIB, Canon, field immersion, research, Education, and study tours.

Coverage

The Office of CEO and Board each have separate dedicated officers. The Board officer attends key board/committee meetings, may meet independent directors appropriately, and prevents exclusively management-filtered understanding without becoming gotcha compliance. Finance has a permanent senior CFO-office presence plus approximately 2–3 working embeds (exact placement count refinable). Temporary coverage follows consequential decision environments such as acquisition, Red Wash expansion, major capital programs, or new regulated exposure—not prestige.

Finance embeds observe beliefs becoming numbers while models are built, test ownership/provenance of assumptions, compare actuals to the belief beneath the variance, create/reopen Judgment Problems when material, and leave the spreadsheet to see operations.

Orientation orients itself through a named Head/Director and professional challenge, not a steering committee.

The Head is first among rigor, not czar of truth.

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